

FDE FIELD NOTES · ISSUE 08 OF 10

Audit logs and the no-write-back rule.

Suggest first. Write later, if ever.

08

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Swipe →

Write-back vs suggest

WRITE-BACK

- Tool updates the record
- Errors spread downstream
- Needs change approval
- Hard to undo

SUGGEST

- Tool shows a suggestion
- Human applies it
- System of record unchanged
- Turn off any time

An audit log that refuses to store

01 IDs, not bodies

Record which item, not what it said.

02 Hashes for proof

Show the input did not change without keeping it.

03 Decision + actor

Suggestion, final choice, who chose.

04 Retention by policy

Deleted on schedule, provably.

One audit record

JSON

```
{
  "item_id": "NT-12",
  "input_sha256": "9f2c...e1",
  "suggestion": "route:triage",
  "final": "route:pharmacy",
  "actor": "operator:42",
  "rule_version": "2026-10-14",
  "blocked": false
}
```

No note body, no patient name. Enough to replay the decision.

If write-back ever comes

- 1 Months of suggest
- 2 Agreement evidence
- 3 Narrow field only
- 4 Change approval
- 5 Reversible write

Earn it field by field, never the whole record.

RULE

The system of record is not your scratchpad.

If you would not let an intern write to it on day one, neither does the tool.



KEY TAKEAWAY

Suggest first, audit decisions, store nothing you do not need.

- No write-back until evidence earns it
- Audit IDs, hashes and decisions
- Retention is part of the design

YOUR TURN

Would your audit log survive a privacy review today?

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Next in the series: #09 Shadow, stop, and replay

Save · Repost

